

BEANS FOR DRYING *various*

Growing beans for drying means that you can enjoy these nutritious vegetables long after the summer crops of fresh beans are over. There is no special technique; you simply leave your beans to dry on the plant until the end of their growing season. Once harvested, they take up little storage space and will keep for several months. Easily grown varieties suitable for drying include lima, cranberry, and kidney beans.

	SPRING	SUMMER	FALL	WINTER
SOW/PLANT				
HARVEST				

SOWING

Beans need full sun and warmth, so delay spring sowing outside until the minimum temperature is around 54°F (12°C). Otherwise, start the seeds off indoors and plant out seedlings only when there is no danger of late frosts. Work plenty of well-rotted compost into the soil before sowing or planting out.

Drying beans come in both bush and climbing varieties. If you are growing bush beans, sow the seeds approximately 2 in (5 cm) apart in staggered rows.

For climbers, make a row of canes or poles, or a teepee, for the plants to scramble up; sow a couple of seeds at the base of each cane, allowing about 12 in (30 cm) space between each plant.



Construct netting for drying beans outside.

CROP CARE

Unless conditions are very dry, there is no need to water your beans until the first flowers appear. Then water generously and regularly, never allowing the soil to dry out completely.

Bush beans may need short supporting canes as they grow. Climbing beans usually twine around their supports without needing to be tied in.